

Introduction Outline

Due Date: **Week 6** on Canvas.

Points: 20 points

Description: Outline organizing the flow of content for your introduction section of your research paper

Instructions: **Draft** an outline for your introduction by building from your literature review worksheet (Assignment 2) and skill practiced in CE 6.

To successfully complete this assignment, you are required to:

1. identify and **cite at least six (6) peer-reviewed references**
 - o read all references and summarize them to organize your thoughts on them
 - o six (6) references total (including Ludwig et al., 2022 and Porter et al., 2022)
2. create an outline of your introduction that includes
 - o Big picture opening and purpose of the current research
 - o references to **six (6) citations**, including comments or information about the references (i.e., what you intend to say about them); please note, the outline suggests citing an article under each manipulation (i.e., IV #1, IV #2, interaction), use it only *as a guide* (e.g., you may have one specific citation that informs your interaction term hypothesis, be flexible and add citations where necessary)
 - o list of references at the end (please see where should add references in APA format)
 - o clear mentioning of your hypotheses
 - o any other material(s) you would like to use or refer to in your introduction section
 - o a final “the current study” explanation

Please use a **word processing program** (such as MS Word) to complete this assignment. The outline does not need to be in complete, grammatical sentences (e.g., include a period for every sentence), but your outline should be complete enough such that you can write your paper using it as your notes.

Strong reminder: *do not copy and paste text directly from another source into your introduction outline (this includes direct quotes); doing so would be considered plagiarism.*

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Introduction Outline Framework

I. Introduce main topic of paper

- i. Everyone experiences conflicts. One of the most important social interactions is conflict resolution. This study attempts to answer the age-old question of how to effectively resolve conflict by looking at what makes a high-quality apology.
- b. Briefly mention relevant key terms or psychological constructs (i.e., intellectual humility; post-transgression response) in a way that a reader new to this area can understand.
 - i. establish key terms used throughout paper
 1. Intellectual humility: individual's ability to identify gaps in their own beliefs and admit to wrongdoing.
 2. Post-transgression response: how a victim responds to conflict after they have been wronged in a situation
 3. General humility: An honest view of one's already established beliefs and importance.
 4. Preemptive forgiveness: The process of forgiving the transgressor before an apology is given.
 5. Empathetic effort:
 6. Self-protection:
 7. High quality apology: apologies that are more likely to resolve conflicts due to the acceptance of blame and relinquishing defensiveness.
 - ii. preview for where your paper is headed (e.g., identify gap in the literature, why it is important to examine our IVs and how our IVs are different or expand upon what has been done in the past)

The predominant issue seems to be the application of post-transgression response mediation. In other words, there needs to be a way to successfully improve the levels of intellectual humility and high quality apologies on a general scale. If we are able to successfully increase intellectual humility levels within our study, it may have significant applications.

Additionally, if we find strong correlations between increased intellectual humility and other manipulatable variables, we may also be able to improve in this domain.

- c. state 3 broad research questions or goals of the current research
 - 1. Does intellectual humility promote higher quality apologies.
 - 2. Does preemptive forgiveness change the response of the transgressor.
 - 3. What personality traits increase post-transgressional reconsolidation
- II. **Integrate previous research (use 4 references in your argument)**
 - a. First, you can introduce conflict and apologies. However, feel free to reorder the outline as needed.
 - i. A conflict between two people involves a transgressor invoking negative emotions within a victim through an action or offense that goes against the victims' beliefs. Apologies seek to resolve conflict by inducing forgiveness in the victim (Ludwig et al. 2022)
 - ii. Apologies are not only beneficial to quickly resolving a conflict, but they can create lasting effects that positively impact relationships (Koetke et al. 2024)
 - i. *Add more studies as needed*
 - b. first IV: **Intellectual humility**
 - i. Intellectual humility is seen as the perfect balance between being confident in your own beliefs and being open to being wrong, and fluctuating between the two as a situation requires (Porter et al. 2022).
 - ii. **Topic sentence:** Individuals with intellectual humility are more likely to relinquish their own pride in their beliefs, and seek to understand (Ludwig et al. 2022). Both of these variables are related to high quality apologies, and therefore there is sufficient reasoning to investigate the correlation between intellectual humility and high quality apologies.
 - iii. *Add more studies as needed from your literature search*
 - c. second IV: **Post-Transgression Response**
 - i. Topic sentence: A victim's post-transgression response influences apology behavior because it changes the transgressor's emotional experience

1. The Effect of Preemptive Forgiveness and a Transgressor's Responsibility on Shame, Motivation to Reconcile, and Repentance (Struthers et al., 2008)
2. Preemptive forgiveness can increase distress in the transgressor, which may lead them to feel guilty. This feeling of guilt usually motivates a person to apologize. However, if the transgressor does not feel responsible for the offense, preemptive forgiveness can backfire and instead create feelings of shame. This shameful feeling can promote the transgressor to pull away, rather than apologize.
3. This study specifically looks at the effect of the victim's response on the transgressor's apology behavior. Our second research question aims to determine whether there is a legitimate effect or not. So, these findings will be extremely useful to tie into the results of our own experiment.

ii. Add more studies as needed

- d. The effects of post-transgression responses on apology (Joshua Robert Guilfoyle, 2015)
- e. This study also looked at the relationship between post-transgressional response and preemptive forgiveness. Specifically it looked not only on the transgressors willingness to apologize, but their level of self-control and their level of social pain. These variables are also somewhat related to intellectual humility and can give us more insight onto what factors into an effective apology, as well as what prevents specific social effects lead someone not to seek reconciliation.
- f. interaction: **Intellectual humility and Post-Transgression response**
 - i. Topic Sentence: Intellectual humility is likely to be most important in the unforgiving condition, as when an individual is not forgiven it may lead them to feel more guilt and therefor be less likely to admit wrongdoing. However, if the individual is rated high in intellectual humility, they would be able to push past the feelings of guilt and apologize regardless.

1. The Effect of Preemptive Forgiveness and a Transgressor's Responsibility on Shame, Motivation to Reconcile, and Repentance (Struthers et al., 2008) The results of this study showed a correlation between apology likelihood related to pre-emptive forgiveness as well as personal responsibility. There was a direct correlation between pre-emptive implied forgiveness and apology likelihood, and an inverse correlation between level of responsibility and apology likelihood.
2. This study is vital for our experiment as it looks at both apology quality and post-transgressional response. Understanding the relationship between intellectual humility and apologies from Ludwig et. al 2022 is only the first part of our hypothesis. Connecting these variables to post-transgressional response is the second, and this study provides us with valuable information in that regard. As a result, we can build onto the existing results this study found which indicated that specific post-transgressional responses can influence apology. We can introduce our second variable, that being intellectual humility, to further investigate this relationship.

ii. Add more studies as needed

III. The current study

- i. Restate the goals of the current study: The goal of our study is to identify whether intellectual humility influences apology quality when an individual is pre-emptively forgiven, or not.
- ii. brief description of procedure for current experiment so that a reader can better understand your hypotheses below. We first initiated a higher level of intellectual humility by having participants reflect on a time they acted with high levels of intellectual humility. After they are primed, we have them read a story where they are the transgressor in a conflict. Then, depending on what condition they are randomly assigned, they are either

preemptively forgiven, or not, by the victim. Finally we ask participants to choose how they would respond, using a multiple choice questionnaire.

State your 3 hypotheses. Hypothesis 1: If the participant is assigned to the IH condition, then their apologies will be more effective than the control group because they are more likely to admit wrong-doing.

Hypothesis 2: If the participant is assigned to the high forgiveness condition, then their apologies will be more effective than the unforgiving condition because they will feel less guilt about their mistake.

Hypothesis 3: If a participant is assigned the high forgiveness condition and the high IH condition, their apologies will be the most effective.

Reference Page

1. on separate page (use page break function if using Word)
2. complete and includes at least five references in APA style (follow APA guidelines for heading, spacing, and formatting)

References

GUILFOYLE, J. R. (2015). The effects of post-transgression responses on apology. YorkSpace Library. <https://yorkspace.library.yorku.ca/server/api/core/bitstreams/29f15e37-c096-40f8-8e31-c6ec0c6cf11d/content>

Ludwig, J. M., Schumann, K., & Porter, T. (2022). Humble and apologetic? Predicting apology quality with intellectual and general humility. *Personality and Individual Differences*, 188, 111477. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.paid.2021.111477>

Koetke, J., Schumann, K., Welker, K., & Coleman, P. T. (2024). Intellectual humility is reliably associated with constructive responses to conflict. *PLoS ONE*, 19(9), 12. <https://doi.org/10.1371/journal.pone.0309848>

Porter, T., Elnakouri, A., Meyers, E. A., Shibayama, T., Jayawickreme, E., & Grossmann, I. (2022). Predictors and consequences of intellectual humility. *Nature Reviews Psychology*, 1(9), 524-536. <https://doi.org/10.1038/s44159-022-00081->

Struthers, C. W., Eaton, J., Shirvani, N., Georghiou, M., & Edell, E. (2008). The Effect of Preemptive Forgiveness and a Transgressor's Responsibility on Shame, Motivation to Reconcile, and Repentance. *Basic and Applied Social Psychology*, 30(2), 130–141.
<https://doi.org/10.1080/01973530802209178>